

THE STARTUP STORY

India's startups are on the verge of a revolution that will put us in the forefront of solving the world's problems

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You don't have to wait for August every year to know that India is a startup hub. Startups in our country have solved problems and opened up new avenues wherever you look. Companies such as Ola, Flipkart, BookMyShow have become household names and they've done that by having a laser focus on customer experience. Most of India's major startup success stories today have come around by developing a business model that is directed at the customer.

India is on the verge of a new wave of innovation. After digitising existing workflows and services, India is focusing on creating products that are all new and its own in every right. Due to this trend, it won't be long before India takes over as the innovation hub of the world. Sounds far fetched? Read on.

THE RIGHT ENVIRONMENT

Before any startup can even begin to affect the world with an idea, there needs to be an environment conducive for that idea to germinate. When it comes to product based startups,

this comes down to patents and IP, and an environment that not only makes it easier to safeguard your own IP but also educates fledgling startups about the whole deal. While individual patents are quite reasonable priced, an entity declaring itself as a business would have to pay many times the amount required from an individual. After new legislation was brought in last year, startups now receive a rebate of 80% when filing for patents, even through the express approval system. Any entity in India recognised as a startup under the Startup India initiative can avail this benefit. The government has also set a goal to bring down patent approval times. It's now possible to acquire a patent in India within a year of its filing. Startups are now using this to their advantage.

THE NEW WAVE OF INNOVATIONS

Log 9 Materials is a Bengaluru based nanotechnology startup that works with graphene. Their expertise falls in the areas of Graphene composites, 3D Graphene and high purity, pristine

Graphene materials. As a startup, they intend to focus on filtration and energy as two problems to solve in our country using graphene. However, the benefit of their research is not limited to our country.

"For us, the last year has been a year of experimentation for perfection", says Mr. Akshay V Singhal, Founder, Log 9 Materials, "For the past 8 months or so we have been in developing the prototype of a product based on metal-air battery concept into viable technology, which will provide a clean and effective solution in terms of energy generation for Electric Vehicles. This will make EVs more viable by providing a driving range of more than 1000 kms and quick charging time. We are also looking forward to create a disruption in the oil spill industry by our graphene-based products which are upto 5 times more effective than current technologies available."

Their products include a graphene based plug-on cigarette filter PPUF. It incorporates nanocomposite filter particles encased in a bio-safe plastic casing which chemically bind cancer